# CSW Process

Iteration of the Completed Staff Work Process / Framework

# CSW Process – ADDRESS IT

*When there is a problem or need that needs staff work, ADDRESS IT!*

**Step 1.**
**Analyze the Context**

**Step 2.**
**Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need**

**Step 3.**
**Research Needed Information**

**Step 4.**
**Explore Options**

**Step 5.**
**Submit Proposal or Report**

**Step 6.**
**Sustain Efforts to Implement the Solution**

**Step 7.**
**Iterate and Improve the Solution**

# Step 1. Analyze the Context

- Clearly understand the assigned issue/task, purpose, objectives, and desired outcomes.
- Assess the office/staff's function, mandate, roles, and responsibilities related to the assignment.
- Identify and analyze relevant stakeholders, their interests, concerns, and perspectives.
- Examine internal/external factors influencing the issue (organizational, political, economic, social, technological, environmental) and review applicable laws, policies, regulations.
- Gather preliminary data and information to establish a foundation for further analysis.

# Step 2. Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need

- Clearly articulate the problem or need based on contextual analysis, describing current situation, gaps, and alignment with objectives.
- Engage relevant stakeholders through consultations and discussions to gain diverse perspectives on the problem/need.
- Identify root causes using techniques like root cause analysis, fishbone diagrams, distinguishing from symptoms.
- Assess potential consequences of addressing or not addressing the problem/need in short and long term.
- Establish the scope, SMART objectives, and document a clear, validated problem/need statement aligned with organizational goals.

# Step 3. Research Needed Information

- Develop a comprehensive research plan outlining information needs, scope, questions, timelines, and resources.
- Identify and utilize credible sources across government, academic, industry, expert, and stakeholder domains.
- Conduct literature reviews, benchmark studies, and best practice analyses to synthesize existing knowledge.
- Collect primary data through surveys, interviews, focus groups, etc. to fill knowledge gaps.
- Analyze and synthesize all research findings to identify potential solutions and best practices.

# Step 4. Explore Options

- Review research findings from Step 3 and identify insights to inform option generation.
- Conduct ideation sessions using creative techniques like brainstorming, mind mapping, engaging stakeholders to generate a wide range of potential options/solutions.
- Evaluate each option's feasibility, effectiveness, efficiency, sustainability, and alignment with objectives and criteria.
- Conduct impact analyses and cost-benefit analyses to assess potential consequences and value of each option.
- Prioritize and refine options based on evaluations, analyses, and stakeholder validation. Document rationale for recommended option(s).

# Step 5. Submit Proposal or Report

Prepare a comprehensive proposal/report presenting the recommended solution(s), including an executive summary, background, problem statement, research findings, and options explored.

Clearly describe the recommended solution(s), justification, benefits, and how it addresses the problem/need and aligns with organizational goals.

Develop a detailed implementation plan outlining specific actions, timelines, resources, roles/responsibilities, milestones, and risk mitigation strategies.

Include monitoring and evaluation frameworks to track progress, measure success, and ensure accountability of the solution's implementation.

Conclude with a call to action, emphasizing benefits and consequences. Obtain supervisor review/endorsement and submit to decision-makers, highlighting expected outcomes.

# Step 6. Sustain Efforts to Implement the Solution

- Continuously seek approval and maintain support from decision-makers and stakeholders, providing regular progress updates.
- After approval, mobilize required resources (personnel, budget, infrastructure) and coordinate with relevant teams for efficient allocation.
- Develop detailed action plans outlining steps, responsibilities, timelines, and ensure clear communication of roles/expectations.
- Provide training, capacity building, ongoing guidance, and support to facilitate effective implementation and address challenges.
- Regularly monitor progress using KPIs, milestones, identify and resolve obstacles, and maintain stakeholder engagement throughout implementation.

# Step 7. Iterate and Improve the Solution

- Continuously monitor and evaluate the implemented solution's effectiveness, efficiency, and impact using established metrics and KPIs.
- Collect feedback from stakeholders (end-users, partners, etc.) through surveys, interviews, focus groups, and other methodologies to identify improvement areas.
- Regularly analyze performance data, identify trends, patterns, and areas excelling or falling short against targets.
- Based on monitoring, evaluation, and feedback, prioritize and implement targeted improvements and refinements to the solution.
- Document lessons learned, best practices, and challenges encountered. Cultivate a culture of continuous improvement, adaptability. Restart CSW process if significant challenges or changing circumstances arise.